

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

A ROARING COMPETITION

So intense is the competition between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and West Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee that one cannot even rule out 'cat fights'. Days after Modi flew down African cheetahs to India, Mamata's forest minister Jyotipriya Mallick announced plans to create four more zoos—the state already has 12—and get African lions from the Hyderabad Zoo and a black panther too. Mamata is also planning tourist safaris at the new animal enclosure in New Town. State capital Kolkata is already buzzing with stories of how the marauding Bengal tigress (Mamata) plans to drown out the roar of the Gujarat lion (Modi).



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SELF-YATRA

Andhra Pradesh chief minister **Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy** is planning to release his biopic before the assembly polls in 2024. Last time around, in 2019, *Yatra*, a biopic on his late father and ex-CM Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy (YSR), had played a key role in ensuring victory for Jagan and his party, the YSRCP (Yuvajana Shramika Rythu Congress Party). *Yatra* director Mahi Raghavapudi is now scripting Jagan's story, but will it be enough to impress voters?

FOE TURNED FRIEND?

Chhattisgarh chief minister **Bhupesh Baghel** and his health minister **T.S. Singhdeo** surprised all last week when they arrived together for the ongoing *bhent mulakat* programme in Kawardha district. In the past few months, the two had been daggers drawn, with Singhdeo even forfeiting his panchayat and rural development portfolio, alleging that he had been bypassed on key departmental decisions. The local media is playing up the new bonhomie, saying "Jai and Veeru are back together". Question is, have the *sholay* (embers) been put out for good?



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR



SHIFTING SANDS

New BJP recruit **Komati Rajagopal Reddy**, who resigned as the Congress MLA to force the November 3 Munugode assembly bypoll in Telangana, is facing fierce protests in his constituency. Recently, locals even stopped his convoy to ask him why he defected. His admission, in a TV interview, that his mining company got a contract worth Rs 18,000 crore from the Centre six months ago, has only added to his woes. With all three sides—Congress, BJP and the ruling TRS—raising the stakes, Munugode is bracing for what looks like the costliest assembly bypoll campaign the state has seen.

AN -ISM OF HIS OWN



Odisha chief minister **Naveen Patnaik** turned 77 on October 16, and received a pleasant gift from his party, the Biju Janata Dal (BJD). It coined a new term—Naveenism—to highlight the principles that have governed Patnaik's life. The party says 'Naveenism' stands for hard work done silently, dedication and tolerance. The idea has been presented as an alternative to today's noisy, propagandist politics, upholding the old adage, 'work more, talk less', say BJD leaders. The formula has certainly worked for Patnaik, who is one of India's longest-serving CMs.

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Kaushik Deka with Romita Datta, Rahul Noronha and Amarnath K. Menon